

RODRIGO PACHECO

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , Columbia University	2021 – 2027 (expected)
M.S. in Economics , University of São Paulo	2021
B.E. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering , University of São Paulo	2016

FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Finance

JOB MARKET PAPER

Priced Out: Financing Frictions and Startup Mortality (with Madhav Malhotra)

Abstract. Startups raise capital in a sequence of rounds, and each round exposes them to financing risk, the possibility that a viable firm fails because it cannot raise its next round on acceptable terms. This paper asks how much startup failure financing risk causes, and what determines it. We develop a dynamic model of staged equity financing in which a firm with stochastic fundamentals must repeatedly return to the market to raise more capital, and we summarize financing frictions as a wedge between the price of outside capital and its frictionless level. Two results organize the analysis. First, because equity is repriced at every round, repricing substitutes for coordination among investors, so the equilibrium is unique and staged equity does not admit self-fulfilling failure. Second, a firm fails when its fundamentals fall below the level at which investors are willing to fund another round, and the wedge raises that level: firms that would survive in a frictionless market fail instead. We estimate the model using a panel of venture-backed firms from PitchBook. A counterfactual that removes the wedge then measures the share of observed startup failures attributable to financing frictions rather than to fundamentals.

WORKING PAPERS

[When Does Disclosure Help? Information and Coordination in Equity Financing](#)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Bank Competition, Productivity and Inequality
Household Assets and the Job Ladder (with Madeline Hanson)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

“Trade in Value-Added: Does MFN Status Matter for Colombian Regions?” (with R. P. Fernandes, I. F. Araújo, and E. A. Haddad). In *The Colombian Economy and Its Regional Structural Challenges*, Springer, 2023.

TEACHING

Instructor, Columbia University

Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG)	Summer 2024, 2025, 2026
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Teaching Assistant, Columbia University

Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG)	Five semesters, 2022 – 2025
Advanced Macroeconomics (UG)	Fall 2025
Macroeconomic Analysis II (M.A.)	Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant, University of São Paulo

Ph.D. core: Macro III–IV, Micro I–II, Real Analysis, Statistics	2020
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Teaching Development Program, Columbia Center for Teaching and Learning
Foundational Track

2025

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Presidential Award for Outstanding Teaching , Finalist, Columbia University	2026
Ralph E. Holben Fellowship , Columbia University	2024
Wueller Teaching Award , Runner-up, Columbia University	2024
Wueller Teaching Award , Columbia University	2023
Romão Mateus Award , Polytechnic School, University of São Paulo	2014

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant , Columbia University For Fernando Cirelli and Christian Moser	2024
Pricing Analyst , Itaú BBA, São Paulo	2016 – 2018
• Developed pricing models and credit-risk simulations for corporate lending • Trained commercial teams on risk-adjusted pricing methodology	
Intern , Itaú BBA, São Paulo	2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R, MATLAB, Python, Stata and Julia **Tools:** ~~TeX~~ $\LaTeX$, Git and MS Office

PERSONAL

Citizenship: Brazilian **US Status:** F-1 Visa **Languages:** Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Jennifer La'O
Professor of Economics
Columbia University
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Hassan Afrouzi
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Columbia University
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Fernando Cirelli
Assistant Professor, SIPA
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